



Human Rights Commission September 15th 2025

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=AcjBVMF_dtc
Publication Date	2025-09-16T09:01:21Z
Target Category	muncie_city

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2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding officer called the Muncie Human Rights Commission regular public meeting to order on September 15th [00:00:34](#).
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Steve Sneed, Gretchen Cheeseman, Andre Mitchell, Kim Miller, Michelle Owen, Melvin Kelly, and Linda (last name not clearly stated).
 - **Members Absent:** Not specified.
 - **Presiding Officer:** Andre Mitchell (initially acting as Vice President, later elevated to President).

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** Commissioners opened the meeting by stating their names for the record, and a formal welcome was extended to new commissioner Steve Sneed [00:00:41](#).
- **Approval of Minutes:** The August meeting minutes were reviewed and approved by voice vote [00:01:40](#).
- **Approval of Agenda:** The meeting agenda was reviewed and approved by voice vote [00:02:10](#).

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:02:42 Director's Report & Staff Retirement:**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Siobhan (Executive Director).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Siobhan reported that the resignation of Steven Nip had been submitted and finalized on Friday of the previous week. She also formally announced her own retirement as Executive Director, effective October 31st, marking her 18th work anniversary. The board thanked her for her extensive service to the Muny community.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational report only; no formal vote required.
- **00:06:54 Scheduling Executive Session for Internal HR Matter:**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Andre Mitchell / Board Leadership.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The board discussed scheduling an executive session to discuss an internal human resources matter prior to the next regular meeting on October 20th. After reviewing multiple dates and scheduling conflicts, the board agreed on Tuesday, September 30th, at 4:30 p.m. (pending confirmation of a larger meeting space at the sanitary district or mayor's office).
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote [00:11:04](#).
- **00:11:27 Executive Director Job Description & Posting Process:**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Andre Mitchell and Gretchen Cheeseman.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The board discussed the process for updating and posting the job description for the upcoming Executive Director vacancy. It was proposed that city HR (Patty) assist with drafting and posting the role via platforms like Indeed. A subcommittee consisting of Kim, Linda, Gretchen, and Siobhan was formed to meet with Patty, review the draft description, and coordinate details.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote [00:18:00](#).
- **00:18:26 Acceptance of Presidential Resignation & Vacancy:**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Andre Mitchell.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The board formally addressed the resignation of former president Steven Nip and the resulting presidential vacancy.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote to accept Steven Nip's resignation [00:19:49](#).
- **00:20:10 Election of Interim Commission President:**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Gretchen Cheeseman.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Gretchen Cheeseman nominated Andre Mitchell to serve as interim president of the Human Rights Commission through the end of the term leading up to reorganization elections on January 1st.

- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote [00:20:51](#).
 - **00:21:10 Election of Vice President:**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Andre Mitchell / Michelle Owen.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Following Andre Mitchell's elevation to President, a vacancy opened for Vice President. Michelle Owen volunteered, noting her board service experience and familiarity with Robert's Rules.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Michelle Owen was nominated, seconded, and approved by voice vote as the new Vice President [00:22:00](#).
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **00:24:23 Anne Thrasher:** Asked a question regarding the online availability of meeting materials, noting that she could not find recent agendas or minutes posted online prior to the meeting. Board members and staff clarified procedures regarding portal updates.
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6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - Attorney Aubrey provided a brief update regarding quarterly education sessions, noting that the board needs to determine a topic for the upcoming November quarter session and finalize a plan at the October meeting.
 - The next regular meeting is scheduled for **Monday, October 20th, at 4:30 p.m.**
 - The special executive session is scheduled for **Tuesday, September 30th, at 4:30 p.m.**
 - **Adjournment:** The meeting was officially adjourned by voice vote [00:25:19](#).
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